

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5♣

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals
N-S Vul

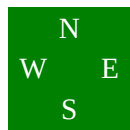
♠ 10 8 6 5
♥ K 9 4 3
♦ 7 4
♣ 8 7 4

♠ A Q 4

♥ A J 10

♦ A Q J 8

♣ K Q 6



♠ K J 7 3

♥ Q 7 6 2

♦ 10 9 3

♣ 9 5

♠ 9 2

♥ 8 5

♦ K 6 5 2

♣ A J 10 3 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	3♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by North			

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♦10.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♦10.

Winner count: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 5 : Total = 11

You need just one more winner. If the ♠K is with West then a simple finesse will provide it. This would not be a terrible plan - you can expect it to succeed 50% of the time. Of course that means you will go down the other 50% of the time.

The double finesse in ♥s is better. If West holds **EITHER** the ♥K **OR** the ♥Q you will succeed. This raises your chances to 75%.

So win the opening lead with dummy's ♦K. Play the ♥5, finessing your ♥10. East will probably win this with either ♥K or ♥Q. No matter. Win East's probable ♦ return and take 5 ♣ tricks, discarding your 2 ♠ losers. Lead dummy's ♥7 and finesse the ♥J. When this wins the rest of the tricks are yours.

Sometimes you will have two or three possible ways to try for a contract. You need to evaluate them as to which is the most likely to succeed. There are times when this can be very difficult to analyze, but fortunately some choices are pretty easy to make.

The choice between a single finesse and a double finesse is one that you will face many times. So remember that the double finesse works 75% of the time.

With 9 points you have enough strength to make a positive response. And with a good 5-card suit you respond 3♣.

Partner says 4NT.

Partner's 4NT bid is clearly Blackwood. With one Ace you answer 5♦.

Partner says 5NT.

Partner's 5NT bid guarantees that your side has all the Aces, and asks for your Kings. With one King you answer 6♦.

Partner says 6NT and you pass.

South would play 6NT.

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Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 3

♥ 6 4

♦ 10 6

♣ K Q 10 8 7 3 2

♠ A Q 10

♥ J 10 9 5 2

♦ J 9 4 3

♣ 5



♠ K 7 6 4

♥ A Q

♦ K Q 8

♣ A J 9 4

♠ J 9 5 2

♥ K 8 7 3

♦ A 7 5 2

♣ 6

West

North

East

South

1♣

Pass

5♣

All Pass

5♣ by East

MAYBE North will have the ♠A and the ♥K. But maybe not. You do have an extra ♦ trick so you need to determine the best use you can make of that.

First pull trumps. It takes one round. Play your other ♦ winner and discard one of dummy's ♠s. This protects you from losing more than one ♠. Enter dummy with a trump and lead the last ♠. Assume North has the ♠A. If he goes up with it you will be able to dump dummy's ♥ loser on your ♠K. If he plays low you put on your ♠K and you no longer have a ♠ loser.

If it turns out South has the ♠A then your ♠ play didn't work. In that case you would enter dummy again and try the ♥ finesse. This plan is a winner if North holds **EITHER** the ♥K or the ♠A.

It's always nice to give yourself two chances.

With correct play you succeed when North holds the ♠A, but also if he holds the ♥K.

The key play was dumping the ♠ on your ♦K rather than a ♥.

This is **NOT** a simple choice.

Partner may have a hand where 3NT is a laydown. Or he may have a hand where 3NT is a godown.

Science isn't going to help you so you guess that 5♣ probably has a good chance.

West would play 5♣.

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East plays 5♣. South leads ♦A, then ♦2.

East plays 5♣. South leads ♦A, then ♦2.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4